

Gabriela Penarska

Product Designer

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Skills

Design

End-to-end product design

UI & visual design

Interaction design

Prototyping

User research & usability testing

Human-centered design

Design systems & components

A/B testing & experimentation

Data-driven insights

Information architecture

Wireframing & sketching

Accessibility (WCAG)

Human-computer interaction

Data visualization

Agentic AI

Tools

Figma, ProtoPie, Framer, Miro, Notion, Adobe

CC

AI tools

Figma Make, Claude Design, Google Stitch,

Claude Code, Codex

Development

HTML, CSS, Python

Languages

Polish (native), English (fluent)

Honours

DTU Green Challenge

0-to-1 mobile app (Android) to reduce food waste, shipped in **8 weeks** and selected to present in front of investors

Interaction 2024, Tokyo

AI-copilot storytelling for children, conference paper selected

DTU Finalist X-Tech Entrepreneurship

AI-driven startup, awarded one week of workshops in Silicon Valley (Nvidia, Plug & Play offices), UC Berkeley and Stanford

Interests

Photography, travel filmmaking, solo

backpacking

Product Designer with **5 years** of experience taking products from ambiguous problem to polished delivery across web, desktop and mobile. My strength is complexity and ambiguity: I reason from first principles and turn sharp problem framing into UI and UX that is intuitive, effective and delightful. I start with an LLM to clarify intent and surface edge cases before opening a design tool, and move between Figma and code — Claude Code, Codex — to reach interactive prototypes fast. I'm extremely ambitious, and I co-create with PMs and engineers from day one.

Experience

UX Designer | Nacos Marine (formerly Wärtsilä)

Jan 2023 – Dec 2025 · Copenhagen

- Shaped high-leverage UI and UX end-to-end, from early concepts to polished delivery, for new vessel monitoring interfaces across web, desktop and HMI, translating complex technical requirements into intuitive, accessible systems that build user trust under high pressure. Delivered to **13 000+ ships** globally, supporting **30k+ daily active users**.
- Cut time-to-task execution by **70%** by transforming high-volume data into high-impact dashboards and monitoring panels handling **70+ active data points** per single page.
- Compressed the time from ambiguity to direction by talking directly with customers: led discovery interviews and usability testing across enterprise and consumer products, and facilitated workshops that aligned stakeholders on direction.
- Validated and measured interaction decisions before build by turning rough concepts into interactive prototypes running on real data, testing alternative directions until the simplest one held up.
- Restructured the information architecture from first principles, cutting navigation depth from **4–5 levels of nested menus to 2** and consolidating **22 functions into 10**, reducing operators' reliance on the manual for core tasks.
- Co-created with product owners, engineers and developers from day one across countries, defining UX requirements early and making engineering-aware design decisions that lowered time-to-critical decision and cognitive load.
- Unlocked business value and won repeat business, a customer ordering a second interface after a successful release, by designing novel end-to-end patterns for vessel navigation that held the brand identity, and presenting the work directly to major customers.

UX/UI Designer | Cytiva

May 2021 – Jan 2023 · Krakow

- Cut daily task-completion time by **30%** for **500+ employees** by leading the redesign of the internal hour-tracking system.
- Designed, co-developed and delivered an end-to-end new desktop customer-ordering tool, moving between Figma and frontend code to get the best result.
- Simplified equipment ordering for sourcing specialists by redesigning procurement data dashboards, informed by qualitative research run directly with users.
- Helped maintain a design system with other designers.
- Partnered with business analysts, developers and project managers, co-designed the company's internal employee website and presented work to customers.

Education

MSc Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence | Technical University of Denmark

Aug 2022 – Mar 2025

Human-centered design, interaction design, data visualization, accessibility, ML foundations. Thesis: a dashboard using data from a wearable button to improve treatment for patients with mental health disorders.

MEng Applied Computer Science | AGH University of Science and Technology

Feb 2021 – Aug 2022

Software engineering, HCI, front-end development. Thesis: ticket platform redesign for **1000+ students**.

Member of BEST AGH Krakow. Coordinated the design team for a Europe-wide conference of **400+ attendees** and grew local recruitment applicants by **15%**.

Exchange student | University of Tokyo · NOVA University of Lisbon

2023/2024 · 2022

HCI, sense of agency.